Open source GDPR solution for financial institutions

Pontus Vision GDPR is an open source, secure, software-based solution. It enables firms to search for any given customer and quickly access all of the data the business holds about them in a single, consolidated view.

Pontus Vision enables global financial institutions and government organisations to efficiently and securely manage their large and complex data requirements. It helps companies to easily and efficiently comply with the EU's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), which is expected to come into force from May 25, 2018.

GDPR is expected to impact every business that processes or collects data from EU citizens. Failure to meet the regulatory requirements could result in significant penalties of up to US$ 24.74 million (€20 million) or 4 per cent of global annual turnover – whichever is higher. To effectively address obligations after GDPR comes into force, firms will need to ensure they protect their customer's data in a standardised, complete and readily accessible manner. Pontus Vision GDPR is an open source solution designed to deliver GCHQ-level security even when data is stored in the cloud. It enables firms to streamline and automate their data management processes, without changing underlying systems or procedures, or implementing potentially restrictive proprietary solutions. This approach considerably reduces the time, cost and effort required to take the steps necessary to achieve GDPR compliance.

Meeting these requirements presents significant challenges for a number of financial services organisations, including retail banks, asset managers and insurance brokers. Many are storing ever-increasing volumes of interrelated client data across multiple database silos in a wide variety of formats.

China unveils open source platform

China's science and technology minister has shared that the government has built an open source platform to boost the development of artificial intelligence (AI) in the country.

According to media reports, switching to open source is expected to make China a world leader in the field of AI by 2030. Offering AI on an open source platform will help with its scientific development.

Addressing the media at the National People's Assembly, Wan Gang, the minister of science and technology said, "Open source platforms are needed because AI can play a bigger role in development and make it easier for entrepreneurs to have access to resources."

AI technology has been in development in China since 1980. The minister shared that now the country wants to lead the sector and hence this national plan – started by President Xi Jinping. The plan involves multiple ministries, in order to be able to apply the technology in all fields. He also highlighted the achievements made in AI over the last few years, such as the development of intelligent vehicles, facial recognition at airports and train stations, or robots that improve the quality of people's lives.

Wan also shared that promotion of scientific R&D has been a key Chinese policy, with increased state investment and incentives. The minister said research gains in China have had a global impact. The plan, launched by China last year, aims to make the country an AI leader in industry, urban planning, agriculture and defence. The plan aims to boost production of AI-related technology to touch the figure of US$ 22 billion by 2020, US$ 60 billion in 2025, and US$ 147 billion by 2030.

Developers can now deliver open source components securely

In an official blog post, CEO and co-founder of Snyk, Guy Podjarny, has shared that as a software service startup, the company wants to continue to help developers find and fix vulnerabilities in their open source code, before it goes into production. For this purpose, the company has announced that it has successfully closed a US$ 7 million Series A round of funding.

As per the blog post, over 120,000 developers use Snyk to find, fix and monitor for vulnerable libraries. Open source libraries provide a tremendously valuable resource for developers, but in today's rapid fire application development environment, it's not always a simple matter to make sure you're using secure code.

The funding was led by Boldstart Ventures and Canaan Partners. Heavybit, FundFire, Peter McKay (from Veeam) and many other unnamed investors also participated.

"The company is built on the premise that the development team is uniquely suited to deal with these security problems before their programs go out into the world, rather than a security team, which tends to be removed from the development process," shared Guy Podjarny. "When software was built over months and years, this approach worked, but at today's development speed, having an outside security team checking the software no longer makes sense," he said.

"This funding is a great testament to the importance of having developers own security and the critical need to secure our use of open source code. It's also a